

STUDENT DRESS CODE

Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) recognizes that all students have the right to dress comfortably at school and to participate in the educational environment free from body-shaming, discrimination or unnecessary discipline. The LCPS student dress code is designed to respect student self-expression while also supporting safe, inclusive, and orderly environments.

This dress code is grounded in the principle that all students deserve to be treated with dignity and respect. Enforcement must be equitable, objective, and free from bias. LCPS is committed to implementing this policy in a manner that does not create barriers to school attendance or reinforce stereotypes or disparities based on actual or perceived race, color, religion, ethnic or national origin, citizenship or immigration status, sex, pregnancy, childbirth or related medical conditions, age, marital status, sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression, socioeconomic level, military status or disability.

Students are expected to comply with the student dress code while attending school or participating in LCPS-sponsored activities. Parents and guardians play an important role in supporting safe and inclusive learning environments by reinforcing these expectations and helping ensure that students are dressed in accordance with the policy.

A. Required and Permissible Student Attire.

1. Students must wear the following while attending school or participating in LCPS-sponsored activities: 1) A non-transparent top and bottom or one-piece garment; 2) Shoes; and 3) Any clothing required by specific courses or activities (e.g., sports uniforms or safety gear).

- a. A top (e.g., a shirt, T-shirt, tank top, sweater or sweatshirt) must cover the sides, mid-back, and lower back; extend to the waist; and feature a neckline that does not extend below the imaginary horizontal line connecting the armpits.
- b. A bottom (e.g., pants, sweatpants, shorts, skirt or leggings) must be worn in a manner that provides full coverage of the lower torso and buttocks.
- c. A one-piece garment (e.g., a jumpsuit or dress) may be worn in place of a top and bottom, provided it meets the coverage requirements for both tops and bottoms outlined above.
- d. When participating in physical education classes, students must:
 - i. Wear clothing that meets the coverage requirements for both tops and bottoms outlined above;

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- ii. Wear athletic shoes (e.g., sneakers, running shoes or tennis shoes) or other shoes that are closed at the toe and heel and securely fastened to the foot; and
- iii. Remove jewelry and other accessories when directed to do so for safety reasons.

2. Students may wear the following while attending school or participating in LCPS-sponsored activities, provided all general coverage requirements outlined in this policy are met:

- a. Hats and other headwear (e.g., caps, beanies or similar item);
- b. Hooded sweatshirts ("hoodies") and other hooded garments, provided that hoods are worn down while indoors unless permitted for religious, cultural, ethnic, or documented medical or disability-related reasons;
- c. Pajama tops and/or bottoms, provided they meet the coverage requirements for tops and bottoms outlined above; and
- d. Attire of religious, cultural or ethnic significance, including, but not limited to, clothing, head coverings (e.g., hijabs, yarmulkes or headwraps), and hairstyles (e.g., braids, locs or cornrows).

B. Prohibited Student Attire.

- 1. Students may not wear clothing or accessories that:
 - a. Depicts or promotes illegal, violent or lewd conduct;
 - b. Depicts or promotes the unlawful possession or use of weapons or prohibited substances, including, but not limited to, alcohol, tobacco, marijuana, controlled substances or drug paraphernalia; or
 - c. Contains language, symbols or imagery that is profane, threatening or discriminatory (including hate speech), or that a reasonable person would foresee as likely to cause a material and substantial disruption or to infringe upon the rights of others.

This provision shall be applied in a viewpoint-neutral manner and in accordance with applicable law. Without limiting the foregoing, prohibited items may include, but are not limited to, language, symbols or imagery associated with criminal street gangs or that have been legally found to have been historically used to intimidate, threaten or demean individuals

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or groups (e.g., the Confederate flag, Swastika or Ku Klux Klan imagery).

2. Students may not wear:
 - a. Clothing that does not meet the coverage requirements for tops and bottoms outlined above;
 - b. Helmets or headwear that obscure the face, except when worn for religious, cultural, ethnic, or documented medical or disability-related reasons;
 - c. Bathing suits, robes or blankets; or
 - d. Any other garment or accessory that the principal, with the concurrence of the Level Director, determines to pose a legitimate safety risk or to materially disrupt the learning environment. If a garment or accessory is prohibited under this provision, the principal shall:
 - i. Provide written notice to staff, students, and parents or guardians explaining the basis for the prohibition; and
 - ii. Ensure such notice is provided at least two weeks prior to the imposition of disciplinary sanctions for wearing the prohibited item, unless an immediate safety concern requires prompt action.

C. Dress Code Enforcement.

1. A student's choice of clothing shall not be considered inherently disruptive to the learning environment, except in cases of clear violations of this policy.
2. The unintentional exposure of undergarments will not result in disciplinary action.
3. School-based administrators are primarily responsible for enforcing the student dress code, allowing teachers to remain focused on instruction.
 - a. Dress code standards shall be enforced consistently, equitably, respectfully, and in a view-point neutral, body-positive manner.
 - b. Students shall only be removed from classrooms or other school spaces when necessary to address a violation, and any resulting loss of instructional time shall be minimized.

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- c. Conversations regarding potential violations must be conducted privately and in a manner that preserves the student's dignity and avoids drawing unnecessary attention to the student's body. When enforcing the student dress code, no LCPS employee shall:
 - i. Make direct physical contact with students or students' attire.
 - ii. Ask or require students to undress or display their bodies in front of others.
 - iii. Body shame, assign blame or suggest that a student's body is a distraction.

4. A student's hairstyle shall not constitute a violation of this policy unless the hairstyle depicts words or images that would violate the prohibitions listed under Section B1 above.

5. Students who violate this policy may be subject to disciplinary action in accordance with the LCPS Guide to Leveled Responses. Student dress code violations should generally be treated as minor infractions. More serious consequences may be applied only in cases of repeated or egregious violations (e.g., clothing displaying hate speech or explicit content).

D. Equity, Non-Discrimination, and Accommodations.

1. Reasonable accommodations shall be provided for students whose attire is associated with religious observance, cultural or ethnic practices, or documented medical or disability-related needs.

- a. Parents or guardians seeking an accommodation not otherwise addressed in this policy should contact the school principal. LCPS officials will work collaboratively with families to provide appropriate accommodations in a timely manner.

2. Students who believe they have been subject to discriminatory enforcement of the dress code, or their parents or guardians on their behalf, are encouraged to bring their concerns to the school principal. If the concern is not resolved at the school level, the student, parent or guardian may submit a Comment and Complaint form, which will be routed to the appropriate office, department or school administrator for review and response.

[Former Policy 8-33]

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Cross Rel: [Policy 8070](#), Written Comments and Complaints